UP-PCS PRELIMS 2026 Â· HIGH PROBABILITY QUESTION BANK

Master Expected Questions — Part 1

High-Yield Questions 001 to 075 (Random Subject Distribution with UPPSC Traps & Ratta Points)

QUESTION RANGE
Questions 001 – 075

PATTERN & STYLE
UPPSC 2024â€"2025 Standard (Statements, A&R, Match Lists)

STUDY FORMAT
Question â†' Options â†' Answer â†' In-Depth Ratta & Trap Notes

TARGET DATE
December 6 Prelims Examination

UPPCS Prelims 2026 Expected Questions — Part 1 (Q001 to Q075)

Subject Distribution: Randomized Full-Spectrum GS (History, Geography, Polity, Science, Environment, Economy, UP Special, Current Affairs)
Exam Standard: Multi-statement, Assertion-Reason, Match Lists & Direct Factual Traps as per UPPSC 2024–2025 Trends

Question 1

Subject: Indian Polity & Governance | **Topic:** Making of the Constitution

Match List-I (Committees of Constituent Assembly) with List-II (Chairmen) and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List-I (Committee) A. Steering Committee
B. Provincial Constitution Committee
C. Union Powers Committee
D. Fundamental Rights Sub-Committee

List-II (Chairman) 1. Jawaharlal Nehru
2. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
3. Dr. Rajendra Prasad
4. J.B. Kripalani

Options: A. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
B. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
C. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
D. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Steering Committee was chaired by Dr. Rajendra Prasad (also Rules of Procedure Committee). - Provincial Constitution Committee was chaired by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel. - Union Powers Committee and Union Constitution Committee were chaired by Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru. - Fundamental Rights Sub-Committee was chaired by J.B. Kripalani (while Minorities Sub-Committee was chaired by H.C. Mukherjee, and the main Advisory Committee was under Sardar Patel). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UPPSC repeatedly traps candidates between the main Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights & Minorities (headed by Sardar Patel) and its Sub-Committees (FR Sub-committee under J.B. Kripalani, Minorities Sub-committee under H.C. Mukherjee).

Question 2

Subject: Geography | **Topic:** Mountain Passes of India

Match List-I (Mountain Pass) with List-II (State / UT) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Pass) A. Shipki La
B. Lipulekh
C. Nathu La
D. Zoji La

List-II (State / UT) 1. Sikkim
2. Himachal Pradesh
3. Ladakh
4. Uttarakhand

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
C. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Shipki La:** Located in Himachal Pradesh (Kinnaur district); the Sutlej river enters India through this pass from Tibet. - **Lipulekh:** Located at the tri-junction of Uttarakhand (Pithoragarh), India, Nepal, and China; vital for the Kailash Mansarovar pilgrimage route. - **Nathu La:** Located in Sikkim (East Sikkim); historic Silk Route branch connecting India with Tibet, reopened in 2006. - **Zoji La:** Located in the UT of Ladakh (connecting Srinagar with Kargil and Leh on Great Himalayas). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Note that Zoji La is in Ladakh (post-2019 reorganization), not J&K UT! Banihal pass is in J&K (Pir Panjal range), whereas Zoji La connects Kashmir valley with Ladakh.

Question 3

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Gandhian Movements Chronology

Arrange the following events of Mahatma Gandhi's early political career in chronological order: 1. Ahmedabad Mill Strike 2. Champaran Satyagraha 3. Kheda Satyagraha 4. Rowlatt Satyagraha

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
B. 2 — 3 — 1 — 4
C. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
D. 2 — 1 — 4 — 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Champaran Satyagraha (April 1917):** First Civil Disobedience in India against Tinkathia system in Bihar (invited by Raj Kumar Shukla). 2. **Ahmedabad Mill Strike (February–March 1918):** First Hunger Strike by Gandhi over plague bonus dispute. 3. **Kheda Satyagraha (March 1918):** First Non-Cooperation movement by Gandhi due to crop failure and revenue remission demand in Gujarat. 4. **Rowlatt Satyagraha (April 1919):** First all-India mass protest against the Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act (Rowlatt Act). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Mnemonic: **CAK** (Champaran -> Ahmedabad -> Kheda). Ahmedabad Mill Strike preceded Kheda Satyagraha by a few weeks in early 1918!

Question 4

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Vitamins & Deficiency Diseases

Match List-I (Vitamin) with List-II (Deficiency Disease / Feature) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Vitamin) A. Vitamin B1 (Thiamine)
B. Vitamin B3 (Niacin)
C. Vitamin D (Calciferol)
D. Vitamin B12 (Cyanocobalamin)

List-II (Disease / Feature) 1. Pellagra (4D syndrome)
2. Beri-Beri
3. Pernicious Anemia & contains Cobalt
4. Rickets in children & Osteomalacia in adults

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Vitamin B1 (Thiamine):** Deficiency causes Beri-Beri (affects cardiovascular and nervous systems; common in populations consuming polished rice). - **Vitamin B3 (Niacin):** Deficiency causes Pellagra, characterized by dermatitis, diarrhea, dementia, and death (4Ds). - **Vitamin D (Calciferol):** Synthesized in skin via sunlight; deficiency causes Rickets (bow legs) in children and Osteomalacia in adults. - **Vitamin B12 (Cyanocobalamin):** Contains the metallic element Cobalt; essential for RBC maturation; deficiency causes Pernicious Anemia. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UPPSC frequently asks which vitamin contains Cobalt (Cyanocobalamin / B12). Remember also: Vitamin C is Ascorbic acid (heat-sensitive, lost on cooking), and Vitamin K (Phylloquinone) is needed for prothrombin synthesis in blood clotting.

Question 5

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** One District One Product (ODOP)

Match List-I (District of UP) with List-II (ODOP Product) and select the correct answer:

List-I (District) A. Bhadohi
B. Kannauj
C. Firozabad
D. Siddharthnagar

List-II (ODOP Product) 1. Glassware & Bangles
2. Handmade Carpets (Dhurries)
3. Kalanamak Rice ("Buddha's Rice")
4. Attar (Perfume) & Essential Oils

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Bhadohi (Sant Ravidas Nagar):** Known globally for hand-knotted Carpets (GI tagged). - **Kannauj:** Known as "Perfume City of India" (Itra/Attar industry from rose, jasmine, and mitti attar). - **Firozabad:** Known as "Suhag Nagari" for Glass bangles and glassware. - **Siddharthnagar:** Famous for aroma-rich Kalanamak Rice (often termed Buddha ka Prasad). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Keep these four locked: Aligarh = Hardware & Locks; Moradabad = Brassware (Peetal Nagri); Saharanpur = Wood Carving; Gorakhpur = Terracotta.

Question 6

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Aquatic Ecosystem & Eutrophication

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A): In a water body suffering from eutrophication, the Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD) increases sharply.
Reason (R): Excessive proliferation of algae and phytoplankton increases the rate of decomposition, which rapidly consumes dissolved oxygen.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Eutrophication occurs due to nutrient enrichment (especially nitrates and phosphates from agricultural runoff and domestic sewage). - This leads to algal blooms. When algae die, decomposers (aerobic bacteria) break down the organic matter and consume high quantities of Dissolved Oxygen (DO). - Therefore, Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD)—which measures the amount of oxygen required by aerobic microorganisms to decompose organic matter—surges dramatically, leading to hypoxia and death of aquatic fauna. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Inverse relationship trap: High BOD means Low Dissolved Oxygen (DO) and HIGH organic pollution. UPPSC often flips this by asking: "Does high BOD mean clean water?" No, high BOD indicates heavily polluted water!

Question 7

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Poverty Estimation Committees

Arrange the following committees associated with Poverty Estimation in India in chronological order: 1. Suresh Tendulkar Committee 2. Y.K. Alagh Committee 3. D.T. Lakdawala Committee 4. C. Rangarajan Committee

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 3 — 1 — 4
B. 3 — 2 — 1 — 4
C. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
D. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Y.K. Alagh Committee (1979):** Defined official poverty line based on calorie intake (2400 kcal/day in rural areas and 2100 kcal/day in urban areas). 2. **D.T. Lakdawala Committee (Task Force 1989, submitted 1993):** Recommended state-specific poverty lines using CPI-AL (rural) and CPI-IW (urban). 3. **Suresh Tendulkar Committee (constituted 2005, submitted 2009):** Shifted away from calorie anchor to a uniform consumption basket including expenditure on health and education (Mixed Reference Period - MRP). Set poverty line at Rs 27/day rural, Rs 33/day urban (21.9% poverty in 2011-12). 4. **C. Rangarajan Committee (constituted 2012, submitted 2014):** Modified Mixed Reference Period (MMRP), revised poverty line to Rs 32/day rural, Rs

47/day urban (29.5% poverty in 2011-12). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Chronology order: **Alagh (1979) -> Lakdawala (1993) -> Tendulkar (2009) -> Rangarajan (2014)**. Tendulkar moved away from calorie-only to education & health consumption.

Question 8

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Nobel Prizes 2024

Consider the following statements regarding the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine 2024: 1. It was awarded jointly to Victor Ambros and Gary Ruvkun. 2. The prize was awarded for the discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation. 3. MicroRNAs are large protein molecules that destroy foreign antigens in human blood.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1 and 2 are correct: The 2024 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was awarded jointly to Victor Ambros and Gary Ruvkun for their groundbreaking discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation. - Statement 3 is incorrect: MicroRNAs are not proteins; they are tiny non-coding RNA molecules (typically 20–24 nucleotides long) that regulate gene expression by binding to messenger RNA (mRNA) and preventing protein translation or triggering mRNA degradation. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UPPSC tests fundamental scientific nature: microRNAs are non-coding ribonucleic acid (RNA) sequences, not antibodies or proteins!

Question 9

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Ashoka's Major Rock Edicts (MRE)

Match List-I (Ashoka's Major Rock Edict) with List-II (Core Subject) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Edict) A. Major Rock Edict I
B. Major Rock Edict II
C. Major Rock Edict XII
D. Major Rock Edict XIII

List-II (Subject) 1. Kalinga war, victory of Dhamma, and mention of Greek rulers (Antiochus, Ptolemy, etc.)
2. Medical treatment for humans and animals; mentions Cholas, Pandyas, Satyaputra, Keralaputra
3. Prohibition of animal sacrifice and festive gatherings
4. Religious tolerance and growth of the essence of all religions

Options: A. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
B. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
C. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
D. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **MRE I:** Prohibits animal slaughter in sacrifice and bans festive gatherings (samajas). - **MRE II:** Mentions medical care for humans and animals, planting of medicinal herbs, and southern contemporary kingdoms (Chola, Pandya, Satyaputra, Keralaputra) and Greek king Antiochus II. - **MRE XII:** Plea for mutual respect and tolerance among all religious sects (Sarva Dharma Sambhava). - **MRE XIII:** Describes the remorse of Ashoka after the horrific Kalinga War (8th regnal year / 261 BCE) and conquest through Dhamma (Dhamma Vijaya) over 5 Hellenistic Greek kings (Antiochus of Syria, Ptolemy of Egypt, Antigonus of Macedonia, Magas of Cyrene, Alexander of Epirus). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** MRE XIII is the longest and most frequently tested edict. Note: Rummindei pillar inscription mentions reduction of land revenue (Bhaga reduced to 1/8th and Bali abolished) at Buddha's birthplace Lumbini!

Question 10

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Major Straits of the World

Match List-I (Strait) with List-II (Water Bodies Connected) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Strait) A. Strait of Hormuz
B. Bab-el-Mandeb
C. Strait of Malacca
D. Strait of Gibraltar

List-II (Water Bodies Connected) 1. Red Sea and Gulf of Aden
2. Persian Gulf and Gulf of Oman
3. Mediterranean Sea and Atlantic Ocean
4. Andaman Sea and South China Sea

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Strait of Hormuz:** Chokepoint connecting Persian Gulf with Gulf of Oman (and Arabian Sea); separates Oman/UAE from Iran. - **Bab-el-Mandeb ("Gate of Tears"):** Connects the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden; separates Yemen (Arabian Peninsula) from Djibouti/Eritrea (Horn of Africa). - **Strait of Malacca:** Connects Andaman Sea (Indian Ocean) with South China Sea (Pacific Ocean); separates Malay Peninsula from Sumatra (Indonesia). - **Strait of Gibraltar ("Key to the Mediterranean"):** Connects Atlantic Ocean with Mediterranean Sea; separates Spain (Europe) from Morocco (Africa). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Remember: Bab-el-Mandeb links Red Sea to Gulf of Aden; Suez Canal links Mediterranean Sea to Red Sea.

Question 11

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Parliament & Rajya Sabha Powers

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A): The Rajya Sabha possesses exclusive constitutional powers not shared by the Lok Sabha to initiate legislation on certain matters.
Reason (R): Under Article 249, the Rajya Sabha can authorize Parliament to make laws on a State List subject, and under Article 312, it can authorize the creation of one or more All-India Services.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Assertion is true: As the council representing states in a federal setup, Rajya Sabha has special exclusive powers. - Reason is true: 1. **Article 249:** If Rajya Sabha passes a resolution supported by not less than two-thirds of members present and voting declaring that it is necessary in the national interest, Parliament can legislate on a State List subject (valid for 1 year). 2. **Article 312:** Parliament can create new All-India Services only if Rajya Sabha passes a resolution by 2/3rd majority of members present and voting. 3. **Article 67(b):** A resolution for the removal of the Vice-President can only originate in the Rajya Sabha. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Resolutions under Article 249 and 312 require a special majority of "2/3rd of members present and voting" in the Rajya Sabha only, not of total membership!

Question 12

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Delhi Sultanate Administration

Match List-I (Administrative Department) with List-II (Founder / Associated Sultan) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Department) A. Diwan-i-Arz (Military Dept)
B. Diwan-i-Kohi (Agriculture Dept)
C. Diwan-i-Mustakhraj (Arrears / Revenue Dept)
D. Diwan-i-Khairat (Charity Dept)

List-II (Sultan) 1. Alauddin Khalji
2. Ghiyasuddin Balban
3. Firoz Shah Tughlaq
4. Muhammad bin Tughlaq

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Diwan-i-Arz:** Military department established by Balban to counter Mongol invasions (headed by Ariz-i-Mumalik). - **Diwan-i-Kohi:** Ministry of agriculture founded by Muhammad bin Tughlaq to bring barren land under cultivation and distribute Sondhar/Takkavi agricultural loans. - **Diwan-i-Mustakhraj:** Department to inquire into and recover arrears of revenue from corrupt officials, created by Alauddin Khalji. - **Diwan-i-Khairat:** Department of charity to assist poor Muslims, orphans, and arrange marriages of destitute girls, established by Firoz Shah Tughlaq (who also created Diwan-i-Bandagan for slaves and Dar-ul-Shafa charity hospital). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Balban created Diwan-i-Arz, but Alauddin Khalji introduced Dagh (branding of horses) and Huliya/Chehra (descriptive rolls of soldiers).

Question 13

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** UP Census 2011 Demographics

Consider the following statements regarding Census 2011 data for Uttar Pradesh: 1. Gautam Buddha Nagar has the highest overall literacy rate among all districts of Uttar Pradesh. 2. Shravasti district has the lowest overall literacy rate as well as the lowest female literacy rate in Uttar Pradesh. 3. Kanpur Nagar has the highest female literacy rate in the state.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are factually accurate: - **Highest Overall Literacy:** Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%), followed by Kanpur Nagar (79.65%) and Auraiya (78.95%). - **Lowest Overall Literacy:** Shravasti (46.74%), followed by Bahraich (49.36%) and Balrampur (49.51%). - **Highest Female Literacy:** Kanpur Nagar (75.05%), followed by Lucknow (71.54%) and Gautam Buddha Nagar (70.82%). - **Lowest Female Literacy:** Shravasti (34.75%), followed by Balrampur (38.43%) and Bahraich (39.18%). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Common trap: Gautam Buddha Nagar leads in overall literacy and male literacy, but Kanpur Nagar tops in female literacy!

Question 14

Subject: General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Optical Phenomena in Daily Life

Match List-I (Phenomenon) with List-II (Underlying Optical Principle) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Phenomenon) A. Mirage in deserts & Sparkle of diamond
B. Blue colour of clear sky
C. Rainbow formation
D. Twinkling of stars

List-II (Optical Principle) 1. Atmospheric Refraction
2. Dispersion, Refraction & Internal Reflection
3. Total Internal Reflection
4. Rayleigh Scattering of light

Options: A. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
B. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
C. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
D. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Total Internal Reflection (TIR):** Occurs when light travels from denser to rarer medium at an angle greater than the critical angle. Explains mirages, brilliance of diamonds, and light propagation through optical fibres and endoscopes. - **Scattering of Light:** Rayleigh's scattering law states scattering intensity is inversely proportional to λ^4. Shorter wavelengths (blue/violet) scatter much more than longer ones, giving the sky its blue color. - **Rainbow:** Composite optical phenomenon involving dispersion, refraction, and internal reflection within water droplets. - **Twinkling of Stars:** Caused by atmospheric refraction

through layers of air with continuously varying refractive indices. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In space or on the Moon (where there is no atmosphere), the sky appears black because there is no scattering of light!

Question 15

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

Match List-I (SDG Number) with List-II (Goal Title) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Goal) A. SDG 1
B. SDG 5
C. SDG 6
D. SDG 13

List-II (Title) 1. Clean Water and Sanitation
2. No Poverty
3. Climate Action
4. Gender Equality

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
C. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **SDG 1:** No Poverty ("End poverty in all its forms everywhere"). - **SDG 2:** Zero Hunger. - **SDG 3:** Good Health and Well-being. - **SDG 4:** Quality Education. - **SDG 5:** Gender Equality. - **SDG 6:** Clean Water and Sanitation. - **SDG 7:** Affordable and Clean Energy. - **SDG 13:** Climate Action. - **SDG 14:** Life Below Water. - **SDG 15:** Life on Land. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UPPSC has asked direct match-the-following on SDGs in 2021, 2022, 2023, and 2024. Memorize SDG 1 to 17 in strict order!

Question 16

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Inflation Indices (WPI vs CPI)

Consider the following statements regarding the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) and Consumer Price Index (CPI) in India: 1. WPI is released by the Office of the Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry, whereas CPI is released by the National Statistical Office (NSO), MoSPI. 2. WPI accounts for the price changes of both goods and services, while CPI accounts only for goods. 3. In CPI (Combined), the 'Food and Beverages' group holds the highest weightage (~45.86%).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 3 only
B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statement 1 is correct: WPI is published monthly by the Office of Economic Adviser (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce & Industry. CPI is published by NSO, Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation. - Statement 2 is incorrect: WPI tracks ONLY goods; services are completely excluded from WPI. CPI covers both goods and services! - Statement 3 is correct: In CPI (Combined base 2012), Food & Beverages has the single largest weight of 45.86%, followed by Housing (10.07%) and Fuel & Light (6.84%). In WPI, Manufactured Products has the highest weight (~64.23%). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Base year trap: Base year of WPI is 2011–12; Base year of CPI is 2012. RBI uses CPI-Combined (Headline) for its inflation targeting framework (4% +/- 2%).

Question 17

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Revolt of 1857 Centers & Leaders

Match List-I (Center of 1857 Revolt) with List-II (Indian Leader) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Center) A. Bareilly
B. Faizabad

C. Allahabad (Prayagraj)
D. Jagdishpur (Bihar)

List-II (Leader) 1. Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah
2. Khan Bahadur Khan
3. Kunwar Singh
4. Maulvi Liaquat Ali

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Bareilly (Rohilkhand):** Led by Khan Bahadur Khan, grandson of Hafiz Rahmat Khan. - **Faizabad:** Led by Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah (native of Madras/Awadh, declared Jihad against the British; British announced a ₹50,000 bounty on him). - **Allahabad (Prayagraj):** Led by Maulvi Liaquat Ali; British forces under Colonel Neill suppressed the rebellion here. - **Jagdishpur (Arrah, Bihar):** Led by the octogenarian zamindar Kunwar Singh and his brother Amar Singh; defeated William Taylor and Vincent Eyre. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** British suppressors: Delhi = John Nicholson & Hudson; Kanpur = Colin Campbell; Lucknow = Colin Campbell; Jhansi = Hugh Rose; Allahabad = Colonel Neill.

Question 18

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Bharat Ratna Awards 2024

In 2024, the Government of India conferred the Bharat Ratna upon five eminent personalities. Who among the following was NOT among the five recipients?

Options: A. Karpoori Thakur
B. Chaudhary Charan Singh
C. M.S. Swaminathan
D. Ratan Tata

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The 5 recipients of Bharat Ratna in 2024 were: 1. **Karpoori Thakur (Posthumous):** Former Chief Minister of Bihar and champion of social justice ("Jan Nayak"). 2. **Lal Krishna Advani:** Veteran statesman and 7th Deputy Prime Minister of India. 3. **P.V. Narasimha Rao (Posthumous):** 9th Prime Minister of India, architect of 1991 economic reforms. 4. **Chaudhary Charan Singh (Posthumous):** 5th Prime Minister of India and champion of farmers. 5. **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan (Posthumous):** Renowned agricultural scientist, father of India's Green Revolution. - Ratan Tata was not awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2024 (he was awarded Padma Vibhushan in 2008 and Assam Baibhav in 2021). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** 2024 saw the highest number of Bharat Ratna awards conferred in a single calendar year (5 recipients), surpassing 1999 (when 4 were awarded).

Question 19

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Ocean Currents (Atlantic & Pacific)

Which of the following ocean currents is a COLD current of the Atlantic Ocean?

Options: A. Gulf Stream
B. Kuroshio Current
C. Benguela Current
D. Brazil Current

Answer: C

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Benguela Current:** Cold ocean current that flows northward along the western coast of Southern Africa (Namibia/South Africa) in the South Atlantic Ocean; responsible for the Namib desert aridity. - **Gulf Stream:** Warm current of the North Atlantic Ocean. - **Brazil Current:** Warm current of the South Atlantic Ocean. - **Kuroshio (Black) Current:** Warm current of the North Pacific Ocean (flowing past Japan). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Master classification of cold currents: - *Atlantic:* Canary (North), Labrador (North), Benguela (South), Falkland (South). - *Pacific:* California (North), Oyashio/Kamchatka (North), Humboldt/Peru (South). - *Indian Ocean:* West Australian Current (cold).

Question 20

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Schedules of the Indian Constitution

Match List-I (Schedule) with List-II (Subject Matter) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Schedule) A. Fourth Schedule
B. Seventh Schedule
C. Eighth Schedule
D. Tenth Schedule

List-II (Subject Matter) 1. Allocation of seats in the Council of States (Rajya Sabha)
2. Official Languages recognized by the Constitution (22 languages)
3. Division of legislative powers into Union, State, and Concurrent Lists
4. Provisions as to disqualification on ground of defection (Anti-Defection Law)

Options: A. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
B. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
C. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
D. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **4th Schedule:** Allocation of seats in Rajya Sabha to States and Union Territories (UP has highest with 31 seats). - **7th Schedule:** Division of powers between Union and States (List I: Union 100 items, List II: State 61 items, List III: Concurrent 52 items). - **8th Schedule:** 22 official languages (originally 14; 21st CAA 1967 added Sindhi; 71st CAA 1992 added Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali; 92nd CAA 2003 added Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali). - **10th Schedule:** Anti-Defection Law, added by the 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1985 (modified by 91st CAA 2003). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Memorize: 5th Schedule = Administration of Scheduled Areas in other states; 6th Schedule = Tribal areas in 4 northeastern states (**AMTM**: Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram; NOT Manipur!).

Question 21

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Indus Valley Civilization Archaeological Sites

Match List-I (Harappan Site) with List-II (Unique Archaeological Finding) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Site) A. Lothal
B. Kalibangan
C. Dholavira
D. Banawali

List-II (Finding) 1. Ploughed field surface & fire altars
2. Giant water reservoirs & 10-character signboard inscription
3. Tidal Dockyard built of baked bricks
4. Terracotta replica of a plough & high-quality barley

Options: A. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
B. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
C. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
D. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Lothal (Gujarat, on Bhogava river):** Rectangular tidal dockyard, rice husk, bead-making factory, Persian gulf seal, double burial. - **Kalibangan (Rajasthan, on Ghaggar river):** Pre-Harappan ploughed agricultural field with furrow marks, rows of fire altars, camel bones, wooden furrow. - **Dholavira (Gujarat, Rann of Kutch):** Unique tripartite city planning (Citadel, Middle Town, Lower Town), sophisticated storm-water harvesting and reservoirs, 10-symbol signboard inscription. - **Banawali (Haryana, Fatehabad district):** Terracotta model of an agricultural plough, radial street pattern, abundance of barley grains. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Dholavira is divided into THREE parts, unlike all other major Harappan cities which are divided into TWO parts (Citadel and Lower Town). Rakhigarhi (Haryana) is the largest IVC site in India.

Question 22

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Endocrine System & Hormones

Match List-I (Hormone) with List-II (Endocrine Gland / Source) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Hormone) A. Insulin
B. Thyroxine
C. Adrenaline
D. Oxytocin

List-II (Source Gland) 1. Posterior Pituitary gland
2. Thyroid gland
3. Beta cells of Islets of Langerhans (Pancreas)
4. Adrenal Medulla

Options: A. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
B. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
C. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
D. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Insulin:** Peptide hormone secreted by Beta ($□eta$) cells of the Islets of Langerhans in the pancreas; lowers blood glucose by promoting glycogenesis. - **Thyroxine (T_4):** Secreted by the thyroid gland; regulates basal metabolic rate (BMR); iodine deficiency leads to Goitre. - **Adrenaline (Epinephrine):** Secreted by the adrenal medulla; known as the "Emergency / 3F Hormone" (Fight, Flight, Fright); elevates heart rate and blood pressure. - **Oxytocin:** Synthesized in the hypothalamus and released by the posterior pituitary gland; stimulates uterine contractions during childbirth and milk ejection from mammary glands ("Love / Bonding hormone"). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Glucagon is secreted by Alpha ($□lpha$) cells of pancreas (raises blood sugar). Oxytocin is synthesized in Hypothalamus, but STORED and RELEASED by Posterior Pituitary (Neurohypophysis).

Question 23

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Fairs and Festivals of UP

Match List-I (Fair / Mela of UP) with List-II (District / Location) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Fair) A. Bateshwar Fair
B. Nauchandi Fair
C. Shakumbhari Devi Fair
D. Dadri Fair

List-II (District) 1. Saharanpur
2. Ballia
3. Agra
4. Meerut

Options: A. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
B. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
C. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
D. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Bateshwar Fair:** Major animal/cattle and camel fair held annually on the banks of Yamuna in Agra district. - **Nauchandi Fair:** Held in Meerut after Holi for about a month; famous symbol of Hindu-Muslim communal harmony (dedicated to Nauchandi Devi and Bale Miyan shrine). - **Shakumbhari Devi Fair:** Held during Navratri at Shakumbhari Devi temple in Saharanpur. - **Dadri Fair:** Famous cattle fair held in Ballia district (named after sage Dardar/Bhrigu). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Other famous UP melas: Devi Patan Mela = Balrampur; Soron Mela = Kasganj; Govind Saheb Mela = Ambedkar Nagar; Syed Salar Mela = Bahraich.

Question 24

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Mughal Battles Chronology

Arrange the following battles fought during the Mughal era in chronological order: 1. Battle of Khanwa 2. Battle of Chausa 3. Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram) 4. Battle of Samugarh

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
B. 1 — 3 — 2 — 4

C. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
D. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Battle of Khanwa (16 March 1527):** Babur defeated Rana Sanga of Mewar (Babur assumed the title of *Ghazi* and declared *Jihad*). 2. **Battle of Chausa (26 June 1539):** Sher Khan (Sher Shah Suri) defeated Mughal Emperor Humayun on the banks of the Ganges. 3. **Battle of Kannauj / Bilgram (17 May 1540):** Sher Shah decisively defeated Humayun, forcing him into 15 years of exile. 4. **Battle of Samugarh (29 May 1658):** Decisive war of succession near Agra where Aurangzeb and Murad defeated their elder brother Dara Shikoh. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Succession war sequence of Shah Jahan's sons: **Bahadurpur (Feb 1658) -> Dharmat (April 1658) -> Samugarh (May 1658) -> Khajwa (Jan 1659) -> Deorai (April 1659)**. Mnemonic: **B-D-S-K-D**.

Question 25

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Ramsar Wetland Sites of Uttar Pradesh

Match List-I (Ramsar Wetland Site) with List-II (District in UP) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Ramsar Site) A. Haiderpur Wetland
B. Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary
C. Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)
D. Saman Bird Sanctuary

List-II (District) 1. Agra
2. Muzaffarnagar / Bijnor
3. Sant Kabir Nagar
4. Mainpuri

Options: A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
B. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
C. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
D. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Haiderpur Wetland:** Located on the border of Muzaffarnagar and Bijnor districts in Western UP (Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary). - **Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary:** Located in Sant Kabir Nagar district (Eastern UP). - **Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake):** Located along Delhi-Agra highway in Agra district. - **Saman Bird Sanctuary:** Located in Mainpuri district. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Uttar Pradesh has 10 designated Ramsar sites. Note: Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary is in Unnao, Sandi is in Hardoi, Samaspur is in Rae Bareli, Parvati Arga is in Gonda, and Sarsai Nawar is in Etawah.

Question 26

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Monetary Policy Instruments

Consider the following statements regarding the quantitative monetary policy tools of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI): 1. Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) is the share of Net Demand and Time Liabilities (NDTL) that commercial banks must maintain in liquid cash with the RBI, and the RBI pays no interest on these reserves. 2. Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR) can be maintained by banks in the form of cash, gold, or approved government securities. 3. Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) allows the RBI to absorb liquidity from commercial banks without providing government collateral in return.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **CRR:** Mandated under Section 42 of RBI Act 1934; banks hold it as unencumbered cash balance with RBI; RBI does NOT pay any interest on CRR balances. - **SLR:** Mandated under Section 24 of Banking Regulation Act 1949; maintained with banks themselves in specified assets (cash, gold, unencumbered G-Secs/Treasury bills). - **SDF:** Introduced in 2022 under amended Section 17 of RBI Act 1934 based on Urjit Patel Committee recommendations; operates as an uncollateralized liquidity absorption window placed 25 bps below the Repo Rate. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Statutory distinction trap: CRR is under RBI Act 1934, whereas SLR is under the Banking Regulation Act 1949!

Question 27

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** International Summits (G20)

Consider the following statements regarding the G20: 1. Under India's G20 Presidency in 2023, the African Union (AU) was admitted as a permanent member of the G20. 2. The theme of India's G20 Presidency was "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam — One Earth, One Family, One Future". 3. The 19th G20 Summit in November 2024 was hosted by South Africa.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1 and 2 are correct: During the 18th G20 Summit held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi (September 2023), the 55-nation African Union was formally inducted as the 21st permanent member. The theme was drawn from Maha Upanishad: "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam". - Statement 3 is incorrect: The 19th G20 Summit in November 2024 was hosted by **Brazil** (in Rio de Janeiro under President Lula da Silva). South Africa hosts the 20th G20 Summit in **2025**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** G20 Troika sequence: 2023 = India -> 2024 = Brazil -> 2025 = South Africa.

Question 28

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Fundamental Rights & Prerogative Writs

Match List-I (Prerogative Writ under Article 32) with List-II (Literal Meaning / Purpose) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Writ) A. Habeas Corpus
B. Mandamus
C. Quo-Warranto
D. Certiorari

List-II (Meaning / Purpose) 1. "We Command" — issued to a public official to perform a mandatory statutory duty
2. "To have the body of" — remedy against illegal or arbitrary detention
3. "To be certified" — issued to quash an order of an inferior court acting without jurisdiction
4. "By what authority" — issued to prevent unlawful usurpation of a public office

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Habeas Corpus:** "You may have the body"; can be issued against BOTH public authorities and private individuals to produce an illegally detained person. - **Mandamus:** "We Command"; issued against public bodies/tribunals/officials to perform a public legal duty; CANNOT be issued against the President, State Governors, or private bodies. - **Quo-Warranto:** "By what authority or warrant"; inquires into the legality of a claim by a person to a substantive public office. - **Certiorari:** "To be certified / informed"; issued by a superior court to quash an order passed by an inferior court/tribunal in excess of jurisdiction or violation of natural justice (both curative and preventive). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Writ jurisdiction of High Courts (Article 226) is broader than that of the Supreme Court (Article 32) because the High Court can issue writs for Fundamental Rights AND ordinary legal rights, whereas the Supreme Court can issue writs ONLY for Fundamental Rights!

Question 29

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Major Industrial Regions of the World

Match List-I (Industrial Region) with List-II (Country) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Region) A. Ruhr Basin
B. Donbas (Donets Basin)
C. Silesia
D. Kanto Plain

List-II (Country) 1. Ukraine
2. Germany
3. Japan
4. Poland

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Ruhr Basin:** Premier coal mining and heavy steel manufacturing region of Germany. - **Donbas (Donets Basin):** Historic coal and steel industrial heartland of eastern Ukraine. - **Silesia (Upper Silesia):** Major coal-mining and industrial basin located in southern Poland. - **Kanto Plain:** Highly industrialized region around Tokyo and Yokohama in Japan. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UPPSC favorite world industrial regions: - Lorraine = France (Iron ore) - Saar & Ruhr = Germany (Coal) - Kuznetsk (Kuzbas) & Ural = Russia (Coal & Metallurgy) - Pittsburgh = USA ("Iron and Steel Capital") - Detroit = USA ("Automobile Capital") - Hanshin = Japan (Osaka-Kobe industrial belt).

Question 30

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** 19th Century Socio-Religious Reform Movements

Match List-I (Organization) with List-II (Founder) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Organization) A. Satyashodhak Samaj
B. Arya Samaj
C. Tattvabodhini Sabha
D. Prarthana Samaj

List-II (Founder) 1. Swami Dayananda Saraswati
2. Jyotirao Phule
3. Dr. Atmaram Pandurang
4. Debendranath Tagore

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Satyashodhak Samaj (1873, Pune):** Founded by Jyotirao Govindrao Phule to liberate lower castes from Brahminical dominance; authored *Gulamgiri* (1873) and *Shetkaryacha Asud*. - **Arya Samaj (1875, Bombay):** Founded by Swami Dayananda Saraswati (Mula Shankara); slogan: "Go Back to the Vedas"; authored *Satyarth Prakash*. - **Tattvabodhini Sabha (1839, Calcutta):** Founded by Debendranath Tagore to promote religious inquiry and Upanishadic wisdom; published *Tattvabodhini Patrika*. - **Prarthana Samaj (1867, Bombay):** Founded by Dr. Atmaram Pandurang with assistance from Keshab Chandra Sen; prominent leaders included M.G. Ranade and R.G. Bhandarkar. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Do not confuse Atmiya Sabha (founded by Raja Ram Mohan Roy in 1815) with Tattvabodhini Sabha (Debendranath Tagore in 1839). Arya Samaj was founded in Bombay in 1875, and shifted headquarters to Lahore in 1877!

Question 31

Subject: General Science (Chemistry) | **Topic:** Chemical Formulas of Daily Compounds

Match List-I (Common Name) with List-II (Chemical Formula) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Compound) A. Baking Soda
B. Washing Soda
C. Plaster of Paris
D. Bleaching Powder

List-II (Chemical Formula) 1. $Na_2CO_3 \cdot 10H_2O$
2. $NaHCO_3$
3. $CaOCl_2$
4. $CaSO_4 \cdot \uparrow rac{1}{2}H_2O$

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Baking Soda:** Sodium Hydrogen Carbonate ($NaHCO_3$); releases CO_2 upon heating, causing dough to rise. - **Washing Soda:** Sodium Carbonate Decahydrate ($Na_2CO_3 \cdot 10H_2O$); used for removing permanent hardness of water. - **Plaster of Paris:** Calcium Sulphate Hemihydrate ($CaSO_4 \cdot \frac{1}{2}H_2O$); prepared by heating Gypsum ($CaSO_4 \cdot 2H_2O$) at 373 K. - **Bleaching Powder:** Calcium Hypochlorite / Oxychloride ($CaOCl_2$); prepared by the action of chlorine gas on dry slaked lime $Ca(OH)_2$. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Plaster of Paris has HALF a water molecule ($\frac{1}{2}H_2O$), while Gypsum has TWO water molecules ($2H_2O$).

Question 32

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Geographical Limits & Bordering Entities

Consider the following statements regarding the geography and boundaries of Uttar Pradesh: 1. Uttar Pradesh shares its state boundary with eight states and one Union Territory. 2. Sonbhadra is the only district in India that shares its borders with four different states. 3. Lalitpur district of Uttar Pradesh is surrounded on three sides by the state of Rajasthan.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statement 1 is correct: UP touches 8 States (Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Bihar) + 1 UT (NCT of Delhi) + 1 Country (Nepal). - Statement 2 is correct: Sonbhadra shares borders with 4 states: Madhya Pradesh (West), Chhattisgarh (South), Jharkhand (South-East), and Bihar (East). - Statement 3 is incorrect: Lalitpur district is surrounded on three sides by **Madhya Pradesh**, NOT Rajasthan! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Extremities of UP: - Northernmost district = Saharanpur (touches HP, UK, Haryana) - Southernmost district = Sonbhadra - Easternmost district = Ballia - Westernmost district = Shamli.

Question 33

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Ecological Principles & Energy Transfer

Consider the following statements regarding ecological pyramids and energy flow: 1. In all ecosystems, the pyramid of energy is always upright and can never be inverted. 2. In deep aquatic ecosystems (ponds and oceans), the pyramid of biomass is typically inverted. 3. Raymond Lindeman's 10% law states that approximately 10% of the energy is transferred from one trophic level to the next higher level.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Pyramid of Energy:** Follows the Second Law of Thermodynamics; energy is continuously dissipated as metabolic heat at each trophic transfer, hence it is ALWAYS upright without exception. - **Pyramid of Biomass in Aquatic Ecosystems:** In oceans and ponds, the standing crop biomass of primary producers (phytoplankton) at any given moment is small because of their microscopic size and rapid turnover, whereas long-lived primary and secondary consumers (zooplankton, fishes) possess larger standing biomass, creating an INVERTED biomass pyramid. - **10% Law (1942):** Formulated by Raymond Lindeman; only about 10% of the organic energy from food is converted into flesh/tissue at the next trophic level. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Remember: Pyramid of energy is NEVER inverted. Pyramid of numbers can be inverted (e.g., single large oak tree supporting thousands of insects and parasites).

Question 34

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Foreign Travelers to Medieval India

Match List-I (Foreign Traveler) with List-II (Visiting Ruler / Dynasty) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Traveler) A. Nicolo de' Conti
B. Abdur Razzaq
C. Domingo Paes
D. Francois Bernier

List-II (Ruler / Court) 1. Deva Raya II (Vijayanagara)
2. Krishnadeva Raya (Vijayanagara)
3. Deva Raya I (Vijayanagara)
4. Aurangzeb / Dara Shikoh (Mughal)

Options: A. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
B. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
C. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
D. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Nicolo de' Conti (Italian, c. 1420):** Visited Vijayanagara during the reign of Deva Raya I. - **Abdur Razzaq (Persian ambassador from Timurid ruler Shah Rukh, c. 1443):** Visited Vijayanagara during the reign of Deva Raya II; remarked: "The city is such that eye has not seen nor ear heard of any place resembling it upon the whole earth." - **Domingo Paes & Duarte Barbosa (Portuguese, c. 1520):** Visited Vijayanagara during the glorious reign of Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva dynasty). - **Francois Bernier (French physician):** Lived in Mughal India (1656–1668) during the war of succession and reign of Aurangzeb; wrote *Travels in the Mogul Empire*. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Ibn Battuta visited Delhi during Muhammad bin Tughlaq (wrote *Rihla*); William Hawkins (1608) and Sir Thomas Roe (1615) visited the court of Jahangir.

Question 35

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSPs)

Match List-I (Article of the Constitution) with List-II (Directive Principle Provision) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Article) A. Article 39A
B. Article 40
C. Article 44
D. Article 48A

List-II (Provision) 1. Organization of Village Panchayats
2. Equal justice and free legal aid
3. Protection and improvement of environment and safeguarding of forests and wildlife
4. Uniform Civil Code for the citizens

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Article 39A:** Added by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976; provides for equal justice and free legal aid to the poor (led to the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987). - **Article 40:** Gandhian principle directing the State to organize Village Panchayats as units of self-government. - **Article 44:** Liberal-intellectual principle directing the State to secure a Uniform Civil Code (UCC) for all citizens throughout India. - **Article 48A:** Added by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976; directs State to protect and improve the environment and safeguard forests and wildlife. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Four DPSPs added by 42nd CAA 1976: Article 39(f) (healthy development of children), Article 39A (free legal aid), Article 43A (workers' participation in management), and Article 48A (environment). Article 43B (cooperative societies) was added by 97th CAA 2011!

Question 36

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Rigvedic Rivers & Modern Equivalents

Match List-I (Rigvedic Ancient Name) with List-II (Modern River Name) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Ancient Name) A. Vitasta
B. Asikni
C. Parushni
D. Shutudri

List-II (Modern Name) 1. Chenab
2. Jhelum
3. Sutlej
4. Ravi

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Vitasta:** Modern Jhelum river (site of the Battle of the Hydaspes between Alexander and Porus). - **Asikni:** Modern Chenab river (largest tributary of the Indus). - **Parushni:** Modern Ravi river (banks of which the famous Battle of Ten Kings / *Dasarajna* was fought). - **Shutudri:** Modern Sutlej river. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Additional Rigvedic names to memorize: - Vipas = Beas - Drishadvati = Ghaggar / Chautang - Kubha = Kabul - Suvastu = Swat - Sadanira = Gandak.

Question 37

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** National Income & Macroeconomic Aggregates

Consider the following statements regarding National Income accounting in India: 1. Gross National Product (GNP) at market prices equals Gross Domestic Product (GDP) plus Net Factor Income from Abroad (NFIA). 2. Net National Product (NNP) at Factor Cost is officially defined as the "National Income" of an economy. 3. Real GDP measures the value of all final goods and services calculated at constant base-year prices, thereby filtering out the effects of price inflation.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **GNP = GDP + NFIA:** Where NFIA = Factor income earned by residents abroad minus Factor income paid to non-residents within the domestic territory. - **National Income = NNP at Factor Cost (NNP_{FC}):** $NNP_{FC} = GNP - ext{Depreciation} - ext{Net Indirect Taxes}$. - **Real GDP vs Nominal GDP:** Nominal GDP evaluates output at current prevailing market prices; Real GDP evaluates output at constant base year prices (current base year 2011–12), isolating pure volume growth. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** GDP Deflator formula: $ ext{GDP Deflator} = rac{ ext{Nominal GDP}}{ ext{Real GDP}} imes 100$. Unlike CPI or WPI which use a fixed basket, the GDP Deflator reflects the price changes of all goods and services produced domestically!

Question 38

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Sports & Paris Olympics 2024

Consider the following statements regarding India's performance at the Paris 2024 Olympic Games: 1. India won a total of 6 medals (1 Silver and 5 Bronze). 2. Manu Bhaker became the first athlete from independent India to win two medals in a single edition of the Olympic Games. 3. Neeraj Chopra won the Silver medal in the Men's Javelin Throw event.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Medal Tally:** 6 medals (1 Silver, 5 Bronze; ranked 71st in the medal table). - **Manu Bhaker:** Won Bronze in Women's 10m Air Pistol individual and another Bronze in 10m Air Pistol Mixed Team event

(partnering Sarabjot Singh). - **Neeraj Chopra:** Won Silver with a throw of 89.45 m (Gold was won by Arshad Nadeem of Pakistan with an Olympic record of 92.97 m). - **Other Bronze Medals:** Swapnil Kusale (Men's 50m Rifle 3 Positions), Indian Men's Hockey Team (defeated Spain 2-1), and Aman Sehrawat (Men's 57kg Freestyle Wrestling). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Trap alert: India did NOT win any Gold medal in Paris 2024. Vinesh Phogat was disqualified from the 50kg final for being 100 grams over the weight limit.

Question 39

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** Peninsular Drainage System

Which of the following Indian rivers flows through a rift valley between the Vindhya and Satpura ranges and empties into the Arabian Sea?

Options: A. Narmada
B. Godavari
C. Mahanadi
D. Krishna

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Narmada River:** Originates from the Amarkantak plateau in Madhya Pradesh; flows westward through a tectonic rift valley bounded by the Vindhyas on the north and the Satpura range on the south. - Forms the picturesque Marble Rocks gorge and Dhuandhar Waterfalls near Jabalpur before draining into the Gulf of Khambhat (Arabian Sea) forming an estuary. - Tapi river also flows in a rift valley south of the Satpura range. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Most peninsular rivers flow eastward into the Bay of Bengal because the Deccan plateau tilts gently eastward. Only Narmada, Tapi, Mahi, and Sabarmati flow west due to faulting/rift valleys!

Question 40

Subject: General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Human Eye & Corrective Lenses

Match List-I (Visual Defect) with List-II (Corrective Lens / Feature) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Defect) A. Myopia (Short-sightedness)
B. Hypermetropia (Long-sightedness)
C. Presbyopia (Old-age defect)
D. Astigmatism

List-II (Correction / Cause) 1. Convex lens (converging lens)
2. Concave lens (diverging lens)
3. Cylindrical lens
4. Bifocal lens

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Myopia:** Image forms in front of the retina because the eyeball is elongated; person cannot see distant objects clearly; corrected using a Concave (diverging) lens. - **Hypermetropia:** Image forms behind the retina because the eyeball is too short; person cannot see nearby objects clearly; corrected using a Convex (converging) lens. - **Presbyopia:** Age-related stiffening of the crystalline lens and weakening of ciliary muscles; corrected using Bifocal lenses (upper portion concave for distance, lower convex for reading). - **Astigmatism:** Caused by irregular curvature of the cornea or lens, preventing uniform focus in all meridians; corrected using Cylindrical lenses. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Quick mnemonic: **My Cave** (Myopia = Concave lens). Power of a concave lens is negative (e.g. -2.5 D); power of a convex lens is positive (+1.5 D).

Question 41

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Minerals and Mining in UP

Match List-I (Mineral) with List-II (District in Uttar Pradesh) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Mineral) A. Uranium
B. Glass Sand (Silica Sand)

C. Limestone
D. Bauxite

List-II (District) 1. Sonbhadra (Kajrahat / Guruma)
2. Lalitpur
3. Banda & Chandauli
4. Prayagraj (Shankargarh)

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Uranium:** Found only in small reserves in **Lalitpur** district of UP. - **Glass Sand / Silica Sand:** High quality glass-making sand is extracted extensively from Shankargarh and Lohgara in **Prayagraj** district. - **Limestone:** High-grade cement-quality limestone occurs in **Sonbhadra** (Kajrahat, Guruma-Kanach-Basahari) and Mirzapur. - **Bauxite:** Deposits occur in Rajhawan (Banda) and Chandraprabha valley in **Chandauli**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Lalitpur is UP's primary mineral treasure-trove: both Uranium and Copper (Sonrai area) are found in Lalitpur. Diaspore and Pyrophyllite are mined in Jhansi, Lalitpur, Hamirpur, and Mahoba.

Question 42

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** British Land Revenue Settlements

Match List-I (Land Revenue System) with List-II (Key Architect / Area) and select the correct answer:

List-I (System) A. Permanent Settlement (Zamindari)
B. Ryotwari System
C. Mahalwari System

List-II (Architect & Area) 1. Thomas Munro and Captain Alexander Read; Madras and Bombay Presidencies
2. Holt Mackenzie and Robert Merttins Bird; Gangetic Valley, NWFP, and Punjab
3. Lord Cornwallis and Sir John Shore; Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa

Options: A. A-3, B-1, C-2
B. A-1, B-3, C-2
C. A-3, B-2, C-1
D. A-2, B-1, C-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Permanent Settlement (1793):** Introduced by Lord Cornwallis in Bengal, Bihar, Orissa, and Varanasi (covering ~19% of British India). Zamindars were recognized as owners of land; revenue fixed perpetually; Company got 10/11th share, Zamindar retained 1/11th. Subject to the infamous "Sunset Law". - **Ryotwari System (1820):** Devised by Alexander Read and Thomas Munro in Madras, Bombay, parts of Assam (~51% of British India). Direct contract between Company and cultivator (Ryot); revenue assessed at 50% of produce and revised periodically. - **Mahalwari System (1822/1833):** Designed by Holt Mackenzie (formalized under William Bentinck by Merttins Bird) in UP, Punjab, and Central Provinces (~30% of British India). Unit of assessment was the village or estate (*Mahal*); village headman (*Lambardar*) collected revenue. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Robert Merttins Bird is revered as the "Father of Land Revenue Settlement in Northern India" (UP/NWFP).

Question 43

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Constitutional Bodies & Corresponding Articles

Match List-I (Constitutional Body) with List-II (Article of Constitution) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Body) A. Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG)
B. Finance Commission
C. Election Commission of India
D. Attorney General for India

List-II (Article) 1. Article 280
2. Article 148
3. Article 76
4. Article 324

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **CAG (Article 148):** Appointed by President; holds office for 6 years or up to 65 years; guardian of public purse; friend, philosopher, and guide of Public Accounts Committee (PAC). - **Finance Commission (Article 280):** Quasi-judicial body constituted by the President every 5th year (16th FC chaired by Dr. Arvind Panagariya). - **Election Commission of India (Article 324):** Superintendence, direction, and control of elections to Parliament, State Legislatures, and offices of President and Vice-President. - **Attorney General (Article 76):** Highest law officer; right of audience in all courts; under Article 88, has right to speak in Parliament without right to vote. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Advocate General of the State is under Article 165; State Finance Commission is under Article 243-I; State Election Commission is under Article 243-K.

Question 44

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 & Amendments

Consider the following statements regarding the Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022: 1. It rationalized the number of schedules from six to four. 2. Schedule I provides the highest level of protection to endangered animal species. 3. The separate schedule for 'Vermin' (formerly Schedule V) has been completely removed.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act 2022 (effective from April 1, 2023) restructured the schedules: - **Schedule I:** Animal species that enjoy the highest level of absolute protection (e.g. Tiger, Snow Leopard, Great Indian Bustard). - **Schedule II:** Animal species with a lesser level of protection. - **Schedule III:** Protected plant species. - **Schedule IV:** Specimens of scheduled fauna and flora listed under CITES Appendices. - The old Schedule V (Vermin) was repealed; the Central Government now issues specific notifications for vermin declarations. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Under the 2022 Amendment, CITES provisions were formally incorporated into Indian law through Schedule IV and designated Management Authorities!

Question 45

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** Highest Peaks of Major Ranges

Match List-I (Mountain Range) with List-II (Highest Peak) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Range) A. Aravalli Range
B. Satpura Range
C. Western Ghats (Sahyadri)
D. Nilgiri Hills

List-II (Highest Peak) 1. Dhupgarh
2. Guru Shikhar
3. Dodabetta
4. Anaimudi

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Aravalli Range:** Guru Shikhar (1,722 m) on Mount Abu in Rajasthan (oldest fold mountain in India). - **Satpura Range:** Dhupgarh (1,350 m) near Pachmarhi in Hoshangabad, Madhya Pradesh. - **Western Ghats (Sahyadri):** Anaimudi (2,695 m) in the Anaimalai Hills of Kerala (also the highest peak in entire South India). - **Nilgiri Hills:** Dodabetta (2,637 m) near Ooty in Tamil Nadu. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Trap between Anaimudi and Dodabetta: Anaimudi is the highest peak of South

India / Western Ghats; Dodabetta is the second highest peak and the highest in the Nilgiris! Highest peak of Eastern Ghats is Arma Konda / Jindhagada (1,690 m) in Andhra Pradesh.

Question 46

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Buddhist Councils Master Matrix

Match List-I (Buddhist Council) with List-II (Patron Ruler & Chairman) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Council) A. First Buddhist Council (483 BCE)
B. Second Buddhist Council (383 BCE)
C. Third Buddhist Council (250 BCE)
D. Fourth Buddhist Council (72 CE)

List-II (Patron & Chairman) 1. Kalashoka (Shishunaga) & Sabakami; Vaishali
2. Ajatashatru (Haryanka) & Mahakassapa; Rajgriha
3. Kanishka (Kushan) & Vasumitra / Ashvaghosha; Kundalvana (Kashmir)
4. Ashoka (Maurya) & Moggaliputta Tissa; Pataliputra

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **1st Council (Rajgriha, Sattapanni cave):** Patron = Ajatashatru; President = Mahakassapa. Compilation of *Sutta Pitaka* (by Ananda) and *Vinaya Pitaka* (by Upali). - **2nd Council (Vaishali):** Patron = Kalashoka (Kakarvarna); President = Sabakami. First schism into Sthaviravadins and Mahasanghikas. - **3rd Council (Pataliputra):** Patron = Ashoka; President = Moggaliputta Tissa. Compilation of *Abhidhamma Pitaka* (philosophical treatise) and expulsion of heretics. - **4th Council (Kundalvana, Kashmir):** Patron = Kanishka; President = Vasumitra (Vice-President = Ashvaghosha). Division into Mahayana and Hinayana sects; *Mahavibhasha Shastra* composed. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Mnemonic for Kings: **AK-AK** (Ajatashatru -> Kalashoka -> Ashoka -> Kanishka). Mnemonic for Places: **R-V-P-K** (Rajgriha -> Vaishali -> Pataliputra -> Kashmir).

Question 47

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Multilateral Groupings (BRICS Expansion)

Which of the following countries formally joined the BRICS grouping as full new members on January 1, 2024? 1. Egypt 2. Ethiopia 3. Iran 4. United Arab Emirates (UAE)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 1, 2 and 3 only
B. 1, 3 and 4 only
C. 2, 3 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - At the 15th BRICS Summit in Johannesburg, South Africa (August 2023), six countries were invited. - On January 1, 2024, **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the United Arab Emirates (UAE)** officially became full members. - Argentina declined the invitation under President Javier Milei. Saudi Arabia participated in meetings as an invited guest but deferred formal ratification. - The 16th BRICS Summit was held in **Kazan, Russia** in October 2024. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Trap alert: Argentina rejected the BRICS membership. Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and UAE are confirmed new full members!

Question 48

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Bhakti Movement & Vedantic Philosophies

Match List-I (Bhakti Acharya) with List-II (Philosophical System) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Acharya) A. Shankaracharya
B. Ramanujacharya
C. Madhvacharya
D. Nimbarkacharya

List-II (Philosophy) 1. Vishishtadvaita (Qualified Non-Dualism)
2. Advaita (Absolute Non-Dualism)
3. Dvaitadvaita (Bhedabheda / Dualistic Non-Dualism)
4. Dvaita (Pure Dualism)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Shankaracharya (8th Century, Kaladi Kerala):** Propounded *Advaita Vedanta* (Nirguna Brahman; Maya concept; established 4 Mathas at Sringeri, Puri, Dwarka, Badrinath). - **Ramanujacharya (11th Century, Sriperumbudur):** Propounded *Vishishtadvaita* (Saguna Brahman; soul and God are distinct yet interconnected; Sri Sampradaya). - **Madhvacharya (13th Century, Karnataka):** Propounded *Dvaita* (strict dualism between Atman and Paramatman; Brahma Sampradaya). - **Nimbarkacharya (12th Century, Andhra):** Propounded *Dvaitadvaita* (Bhedabheda; Sanakadi Sampradaya; worship of Radha-Krishna). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Vallabhacharya propounded *Shuddhadvaita* (Pure Non-Dualism) and founded the Pushtimarg sect!

Question 49

Subject: Indian Economy & Demographics | **Topic:** Census 2011 Master Indicators

Consider the following statements regarding the Census of India 2011: 1. The decadal population growth rate of India during 2001–2011 was 17.70%. 2. Meghalaya recorded the highest decadal population growth rate among all states. 3. Nagaland was the only state that recorded a negative decadal population growth rate (-0.58%).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Decadal Growth Rate:** India's population grew by 17.70% (17.64% in rural areas, 31.80% in urban areas). - **Highest Decadal Growth:** Meghalaya recorded the highest growth of 27.95% among states (Dadra & Nagar Haveli was highest among UTs at 55.88%). - **Negative Growth:** Nagaland registered a negative decadal growth of -0.58% (declined from 19.9 lakh to 19.78 lakh). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** India's overall Sex Ratio in Census 2011 is 943 (up from 933 in 2001). However, Child Sex Ratio (0–6 years) dropped alarmingly from 927 (2001) to 919 (2011)!

Question 50

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Agro-Climatic Zones & Bundelkhand Soils

Consider the following statements regarding Uttar Pradesh's agriculture and soils: 1. Uttar Pradesh has been divided into nine distinct agro-climatic zones by the Planning Commission. 2. In the Bundelkhand region, the coarse red and brown soils are locally known as 'Rakar' and 'Parwa'. 3. The black soils of Bundelkhand are locally termed 'Mar' and 'Kabar'.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **9 Agro-Climatic Zones of UP:** 1. Bhabhar & Tarai Zone, 2. Western Plain, 3. Mid-Western Plain, 4. South-Western Semi-Arid Zone, 5. Central Plain, 6. Bundelkhand Zone, 7. North-Eastern Plain, 8. Eastern Plain, 9. Vindhyan Zone. - **Bundelkhand Soils:** - *Red Soil group:* **Parwa** (light sandy-loam, light brown) and **Rakar** (coarse, gravelly red soil found on hill slopes). - *Black Soil group:* **Mar** (highly clayey black soil containing calcareous nodules, retains moisture) and **Kabar** (dark, sticky black soil, very difficult to cultivate when dry). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UPPSC has asked repeatedly: "How many Agro-climatic zones are in UP?" The answer is strictly 9!

Question 51

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Human Blood Groups & Circulation

Consider the following statements regarding the human ABO and Rh blood group systems: 1. Karl Landsteiner discovered the ABO blood group system in humans. 2. Individuals with blood group O negative (O^-) are universal donors because their red blood cells carry neither A nor B surface antigens nor the Rh antigen. 3. Blood group AB positive (AB^+) individuals are universal recipients because their plasma contains both anti-A and anti-B antibodies.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1 and 2 are correct: Karl Landsteiner discovered the ABO system (awarded Nobel Prize in 1930). O^- blood lacks A, B, and Rh antigens, hence causing no agglutination in recipients. - Statement 3 is incorrect: Blood group AB individuals have NEITHER anti-A NOR anti-B antibodies in their plasma (if they had antibodies, they would destroy their own red blood cells!). Because of the absence of antibodies, AB^+ can receive red blood cells from any blood group. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Antigens reside on RBC membranes; Antibodies reside in blood plasma! Erythroblastosis foetalis occurs when an Rh^- mother carries an Rh^+ fetus for the second time.

Question 52

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Constitutional Acts of British India

Arrange the following British enactments in chronological order: 1. Pitts India Act 2. Regulating Act 3. Charter Act establishing open competition for Civil Services (Charter Act of 1853) 4. Government of India Act (Act for the Better Government of India)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
B. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
C. 2 — 3 — 1 — 4
D. 2 — 1 — 4 — 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Regulating Act of 1773:** First attempt by British Parliament to regulate East India Company; Governor of Bengal made Governor-General of Bengal (Warren Hastings); Supreme Court established at Calcutta (1774, Chief Justice Sir Elijah Impey). 2. **Pitts India Act of 1784:** Established Dual Control (Board of Control for political affairs and Court of Directors for commercial affairs). 3. **Charter Act of 1853:** Introduced open competitive examination for Civil Services (Macaulay Committee on ICS appointed in 1854); separated executive and legislative functions of the Governor-General's Council. 4. **Government of India Act of 1858:** Abolished Company rule; transferred governance to the British Crown; created office of Secretary of State for India and made Governor-General the Viceroy (Lord Canning). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The Charter Act of 1833 attempted open competition for ICS but it was negated due to opposition from the Court of Directors; open competition was finally enacted in 1853!

Question 53

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Panchayati Raj Committees Chronology

Arrange the following committees related to Panchayati Raj in India in chronological sequence: 1. Ashok Mehta Committee 2. Balwant Rai Mehta Committee 3. L.M. Singhvi Committee 4. G.V.K. Rao Committee

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 1 — 4 — 3
B. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3
C. 2 — 4 — 1 — 3
D. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957):** Recommended a 3-tier Panchayati Raj system (Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zilla Parishad). Rajasthan was the 1st state to establish PR at Nagaur (2 Oct 1959), followed by Andhra

Pradesh. 2. **Ashok Mehta Committee (1977, Janata Govt):** Recommended a 2-tier system (Mandal Panchayat and Zilla Parishad) and compulsory taxation powers. 3. **G.V.K. Rao Committee (1985, Planning Commission):** Emphasized making Zilla Parishad the pivotal tier ("grass without roots"). 4. **L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986):** First strongly recommended **Constitutional recognition, protection, and preservation** for Panchayati Raj bodies, leading to the 73rd Amendment Act 1992. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Chronology mnemonic: **B-A-G-L** (Balwant Rai 1957 -> Ashok Mehta 1977 -> GVK Rao 1985 -> LM Singhvi 1986). P.K. Thungon Committee followed in 1988!

Question 54

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** Major Mineral Mines of India

Match List-I (Mining Center) with List-II (Principal Mineral Extracted) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Mine) A. Khetri
B. Kolar & Hutti
C. Kudremukh
D. Jaduguda

List-II (Mineral) 1. Uranium
2. Gold
3. Copper
4. Iron Ore

Options: A. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
B. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
C. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
D. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Khetri (Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan):** India's premier copper mining center operated by Hindustan Copper Ltd. - **Kolar & Hutti (Karnataka):** Historic deep gold mines of India (Hutti is the only active gold-producing mine in India). - **Kudremukh (Chikkamagaluru, Karnataka):** Famous magnetite iron ore deposits (named after its horse-face shaped peak). - **Jaduguda (Singhbhum, Jharkhand):** India's first and primary uranium mine, operated by Uranium Corporation of India (UCIL). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Other mineral centers repeatedly matched by UPPSC: - Balaghat (MP) = Manganese & Copper - Panna (MP) = Diamonds - Bailadila (Chhattisgarh) = High-grade Haematite Iron Ore (exported to Japan via Visakhapatnam port) - Makrana (Rajasthan) = High-grade White Marble.

Question 55

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** International Environmental Treaties

Match List-I (International Convention) with List-II (Objective / Target Substance) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Convention) A. Montreal Protocol (1987)
B. Basel Convention (1989)
C. Stockholm Convention (2001)
D. Minamata Convention (2013)

List-II (Target / Objective) 1. Control of transboundary movements of hazardous wastes
2. Protection of human health and environment from Mercury emissions
3. Phasing out Ozone Depleting Substances (CFCs, Halons)
4. Elimination or restriction of Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs)

Options: A. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
B. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2
C. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
D. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Montreal Protocol (1987):** Most successful treaty; phases out ODS (CFCs, HCFCs); amended by Kigali Amendment (2016) to phase down HFCs (potent greenhouse gases). - **Basel Convention (1989):** Regulates transboundary movement and disposal of hazardous wastes. - **Stockholm Convention (2001):** Aims to eliminate the "Dirty Dozen" Persistent Organic Pollutants (e.g. DDT, Dioxins, PCBs). - **Minamata Convention (2013):** Global treaty to protect human health and environment from

anthropogenic emissions of Mercury. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Rotterdam Convention (1998) is for "Prior Informed Consent (PIC) procedure for certain hazardous chemicals and pesticides in international trade".

Question 56

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Global Indices & Reports 2024

Consider the following statements regarding international indices: 1. The Human Development Index (HDI) is published annually by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). 2. The four indicators used in HDI calculation are: Life Expectancy at birth, Expected Years of Schooling, Mean Years of Schooling, and Gross National Income (GNI) per capita (PPP). 3. The Global Hunger Index (GHI) is jointly published by Welthungerhilfe and Concern Worldwide.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **HDI:** Formulated by Pakistani economist Mahbub ul Haq and Amartya Sen; published by UNDP since 1990. - **4 Indicators across 3 Dimensions:** Health (Life expectancy at birth), Education (Expected years of schooling for children and Mean years of schooling for adults aged 25+), Standard of Living (GNI per capita in PPP \$). In HDI 2023–24, India ranked 134th (score 0.644, medium human development). - **Global Hunger Index (GHI):** Released by Concern Worldwide (Ireland) and Welthungerhilfe (Germany); calculates hunger based on 4 indicators: Undernourishment, Child Stunting, Child Wasting, and Child Mortality. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Note that World Bank does NOT publish HDI. World Bank publishes the World Development Report and Logistics Performance Index. WEF publishes Global Gender Gap Report!

Question 57

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Historical Monuments and Architecture of UP

Match List-I (Monument in UP) with List-II (Builder / Ruler) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Monument) A. Bara Imambara (Lucknow)
B. Buland Darwaza (Fatehpur Sikri)
C. Tomb of Itmad-ud-Daulah (Agra)
D. Atala Masjid (Jaunpur)

List-II (Builder / Architect) 1. Akbar
2. Asaf-ud-Daula
3. Ibrahim Shah Sharqi
4. Nur Jahan

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Bara Imambara (Lucknow):** Built in 1784 by Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula as a famine relief project; famous for its unsupported central vaulted gallery and Bhool Bhulaiya (labyrinth). - **Buland Darwaza (Fatehpur Sikri):** Constructed by Mughal Emperor Akbar in 1601 to commemorate his victory over Gujarat. - **Tomb of Itmad-ud-Daulah (Agra):** Built by Empress Nur Jahan for her father Mirza Ghiyas Beg (1622–1628); first Mughal structure constructed entirely in white marble utilizing extensive *Pietra Dura* (inlaid precious stonework). - **Atala Masjid (Jaunpur):** Completed in 1408 by Sultan Ibrahim Shah Sharqi; masterpiece of the Sharqi style of architecture (Jaunpur was known as *Shiraz-e-Hind*). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Itmad-ud-Daulah's tomb is often termed the "Baby Taj" or draft of the Taj Mahal due to its pioneering Pietra Dura marble work.

Question 58

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** 16 Mahajanapadas & Capitals (6th Century BCE)

Match List-I (Mahajanapada) with List-II (Capital) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Mahajanapada) A. Kosala
B. Vatsa
C. Anga
D. Matsya

List-II (Capital) 1. Kaushambi
2. Shravasti
3. Viratnagar
4. Champa

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Kosala:** Capital was Shravasti (Northern) / Ayodhya-Kushavati (Southern); King Prasenjit was a contemporary of Buddha. - **Vatsa:** Capital was Kaushambi on the Yamuna river (near modern Prayagraj); King Udayana was a contemporary of Buddha. - **Anga:** Capital was Champa (near Bhagalpur/Munger in Bihar); later annexed to Magadha by Bimbisara. - **Matsya:** Capital was Viratnagar (Jaipur-Alwar-Bharatpur region of Rajasthan). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Out of 16 Mahajanapadas mentioned in the Buddhist text *Anguttara Nikaya* and Jain text *Bhagavati Sutra*, **8 Mahajanapadas were located in present-day Uttar Pradesh**: Kashi, Kosala, Vatsa, Malla, Chedi, Kuru, Panchala, and Surasena!

Question 59

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Plant Hormones (Phytohormones)

Match List-I (Plant Hormone) with List-II (Primary Physiological Function) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Hormone) A. Auxin
B. Gibberellin
C. Cytokinin
D. Ethylene

List-II (Function) 1. Cell division and delaying leaf senescence
2. Apical dominance and phototropism
3. Gaseous hormone responsible for fruit ripening
4. Stem elongation and breaking seed dormancy (bolting)

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Auxin (IAA):** Promotes apical dominance, cell elongation, and phototropic bending of shoot tips. - **Gibberellin (GA_3):** Induces internodal elongation, stem growth, breaks seed dormancy, and causes "bolting" in rosette plants (like cabbage). - **Cytokinin:** Promotes rapid cell division (cytokinesis); overcomes apical dominance and delays senescence (Richmond-Lang effect). - **Ethylene (C_2H_4):** The ONLY natural gaseous plant hormone; accelerates fruit ripening and triggers abscission of leaves and flowers. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Abscisic Acid (ABA) is known as the "Stress Hormone" because it induces stomatal closure during water deficit and promotes dormancy.

Question 60

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Types of Unemployment

Match List-I (Type of Unemployment) with List-II (Definition / Key Feature) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Type) A. Disguised Unemployment
B. Structural Unemployment
C. Frictional Unemployment
D. Cyclical Unemployment

List-II (Feature) 1. Mismatch between the skills possessed by workers and the requirements of available jobs
2. Temporary unemployment while a worker searches for or transitions between jobs

3. Marginal productivity of the worker is zero or near zero (common in Indian agriculture)
4. Results from economic downturns or recessions due to deficiency of aggregate demand

Options: A. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
B. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
C. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
D. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Disguised Unemployment:** Situation where more people are engaged in an activity than actually required; if some workers are withdrawn, total output remains unaffected (Marginal Physical Productivity = 0). Rampant in small-holder Indian farming. - **Structural Unemployment:** Arises from long-term changes in economic structure, technological obsolescence, or skill mismatches. - **Frictional Unemployment:** Voluntary and short-term unemployment when individuals search for better employment opportunities. - **Cyclical Unemployment:** Caused by trade cycles and recessions (Keynesian unemployment). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UPPSC question trap: "In which sector is disguised unemployment most prevalent in India?" Answer: Agriculture (Primary Sector).

Question 61

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Basic Structure Doctrine Landmark Cases

Arrange the following Supreme Court landmark judgments in chronological sequence: 1. Golaknath v. State of Punjab 2. Shankari Prasad v. Union of India 3. Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala 4. Minerva Mills v. Union of India

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
B. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
C. 2 — 3 — 1 — 4
D. 3 — 1 — 2 — 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Shankari Prasad (1951):** SC ruled Parliament has absolute power to amend Fundamental Rights under Article 368; constitutional amendment acts are not "law" within the meaning of Article 13(2). 2. **Golaknath (1967):** 11-judge bench ruled Fundamental Rights are transcendental and sacrosanct; Parliament CANNOT amend or abridge Fundamental Rights. 3. **Kesavananda Bharati (24 April 1973):** Historic 13-judge bench (7:6 majority); overruled Golaknath; ruled Parliament can amend any part of the Constitution including Fundamental Rights, BUT cannot alter the "Basic Structure" of the Constitution. 4. **Minerva Mills (1980):** Reaffirmed Basic Structure doctrine; struck down clauses (4) and (5) of Article 368 added by 42nd CAA; held that the balance between Fundamental Rights (Part III) and DPSPs (Part IV) is a bedrock of the Basic Structure. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Landmark sequence: **Shankari Prasad (1951) -> Sajjan Singh (1965) -> Golaknath (1967) -> Kesavananda (1973) -> Minerva Mills (1980) -> Waman Rao (1981)**.

Question 62

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Tribal and Peasant Uprisings Chronology

Arrange the following tribal and peasant uprisings in chronological order: 1. Santhal Rebellion 2. Indigo Revolt (Neel Bidroha) 3. Pabna Peasant Uprising 4. Moplah (Malabar) Rebellion

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
B. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
C. 1 — 3 — 2 — 4
D. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Santhal Rebellion (1855–1856):** Led by brothers Sidhu and Kanhu in Daman-i-Koh (Rajmahal Hills, Bihar/Jharkhand) against zamindars, moneylenders (Mahajans), and British officials. 2. **Indigo Revolt (1859–1860):** Started at Govindpur (Nadia district, Bengal) led by Bishnu Charan Biswas and Digambar Biswas against oppressive European planters; dramatized by Dinabandhu Mitra in *Nil Darpan*. 3. **Pabna Peasant Revolt (1873–1876):** Agrarian league formed in Yusufshahi pargana of Pabna (Bengal) against illegal cesses and evictions by zamindars; slogan: "We want to be the ryots of Her Majesty the Queen and of her only". 4. **Moplah Rebellion (1921):** Uprising of Muslim peasants (Moplahs) against Hindu landlords (Jenmis) and British authorities in the

Malabar region of Kerala during the Non-Cooperation and Khilafat movements. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Indigo revolt (1859–60) occurred immediately after the 1857 Revolt. Eka Movement in Awadh occurred in 1921 (led by Madari Pasi).

Question 63

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Major Lakes of the World

Match List-I (Lake) with List-II (Distinct Geographical Superlative) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Lake) A. Lake Baikal
B. Caspian Sea
C. Lake Tanganyika
D. Lake Superior

List-II (Superlative) 1. World's largest inland body of water by surface area
2. World's deepest and oldest freshwater lake
3. World's largest freshwater lake by surface area
4. World's longest freshwater lake

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Lake Baikal (Siberia, Russia):** Deepest lake in the world (1,642 m) and holds ~20% of the world's unfrozen surface freshwater. - **Caspian Sea:** Largest enclosed inland body of water on Earth (saline); bordered by 5 countries (Russia, Kazakhstan, Turkmenistan, Iran, Azerbaijan). - **Lake Tanganyika (East Africa):** Longest freshwater lake in the world (~673 km) and second deepest. - **Lake Superior (USA–Canada border):** Largest freshwater lake in the world by surface area (82,100 sq km). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Lake Victoria is the largest lake in Africa, and the Equator passes directly through it! Aral Sea (between Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan) has shrunk drastically due to diversion of Amu Darya and Syr Darya rivers.

Question 64

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Joint Military & Bilateral Exercises

Match List-I (Joint Military Exercise) with List-II (Partner Country with India) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Exercise) A. Surya Kiran
B. Mitra Shakti
C. Nomadic Elephant
D. Garuda

List-II (Partner Country) 1. Sri Lanka
2. Nepal
3. France
4. Mongolia

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Surya Kiran:** Annual bilateral army exercise between India and Nepal. - **Mitra Shakti:** Joint military exercise between India and Sri Lanka (SLINEX is naval). - **Nomadic Elephant:** Bilateral military training exercise between India and Mongolia. - **Garuda:** Bilateral air force exercise between India and France (Varuna is naval, Shakti is army). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Quick cheat-sheet of recurring exercises: - Yudh Abhyas & Vajra Prahar = India & USA - Sampriti & Bongo Sagar = India & Bangladesh - Dharma Guardian & JIMEX = India & Japan - Malabar = Quad nations (India, USA, Japan, Australia).

Question 65

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** National Parks and Tiger Reserves of UP

Consider the following statements regarding Tiger Reserves in Uttar Pradesh: 1. Dudhwa National Park is the only National Park located in Uttar Pradesh. 2. Amangarh Tiger Reserve acts as an eco-buffer zone for the Jim Corbett National Park. 3. Ranipur Tiger Reserve in Chitrakoot district was notified as the 4th Tiger Reserve of Uttar Pradesh.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Dudhwa National Park:** Situated in Lakhimpur Kheri district (Terai belt); established in 1977; declared a Tiger Reserve under Project Tiger in 1987. It is the ONLY National Park in UP. - **Amangarh Tiger Reserve (Bijnor district):** Formed out of the buffer zone of Corbett Tiger Reserve after Uttarakhand was carved out of UP in 2000. - **Ranipur Tiger Reserve (Chitrakoot district, Bundelkhand):** Notified in 2022 as UP's 4th Tiger Reserve (and India's 53rd Tiger Reserve). - **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve:** Situated in Pilibhit and Shahjahanpur districts (won the international TX2 award for doubling tiger numbers). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** 4 Tiger Reserves in UP: **1. Dudhwa, 2. Pilibhit, 3. Amangarh, 4. Ranipur**.

Question 66

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Mughal Land Revenue & Administrative Terms

Match List-I (Mughal Term) with List-II (Definition / Nature) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Term) A. Khalisa
B. Jagir
C. Madad-i-Maash (Sayurghal)
D. Muqaddam / Patel

List-II (Definition) 1. Land whose revenue was directly collected for the Imperial Royal Treasury
2. Village headman responsible for local administration and revenue assistance
3. Revenue assignment granted to mansabdars in lieu of cash salary
4. Rent-free land grant given to scholars, religious saints, and charitable institutions

Options: A. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2
B. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
C. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2
D. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Khalisa:** Crown land administered directly by the central revenue ministry, revenue from which went directly to the imperial treasury (*Bait-ul-Mal*). - **Jagir:** Land revenue assignment granted to a Mansabdar according to his salary rank (*Tankhwah Jagir*); Mansabdar did not own the land, only held the right to collect revenue. - **Madad-i-Maash (also called Suyurghal):** Tax-free land grant bestowed upon learned men, poets, religious mendicants, and destitute widows. - **Muqaddam / Patel:** Village headman who assisted the Patwari in collecting village revenues. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Todar Mal introduced the **Ain-i-Dahsala** system in 1580 under Akbar, where average produce and average prices of preceding 10 years (1570–1580) were calculated.

Question 67

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Biosphere Reserves under UNESCO MAB Program

Which was the FIRST Biosphere Reserve established in India, and in which year was it designated?

Options: A. Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve (1986)
B. Sundarbans Biosphere Reserve (1989)
C. Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve (1988)
D. Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve (1989)

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve:** India's FIRST Biosphere Reserve, established in **1986**. It spans across parts of three states: Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and Karnataka. - Encompasses protected areas including Mudumalai, Mukurthi, Wayanad, Bandipur, Nagarhole, and Silent Valley National Parks. - Home to the endangered Lion-tailed Macaque and Nilgiri Tahr. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** India has 18 designated Biosphere Reserves, out of which **12 are recognized under UNESCO's World Network of**

Biosphere Reserves (WNBR - Man and the Biosphere Program). Panna Biosphere Reserve (MP) was the 12th reserve inducted into UNESCO MAB in 2020!

Question 68

Subject: General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Physical Units and Quantities

Match List-I (Physical Quantity) with List-II (Standard Unit) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Quantity) A. Astronomical Distance
B. Wavelength of Light
C. Radioactivity
D. Power of a Lens

List-II (Unit) 1. Angstrom ($ ext{\AA}$)
2. Parsec
3. Dioptre (D)
4. Becquerel (Bq) / Curie

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Parsec (Parallactic Second):** Largest practical unit of astronomical distance. $1 ext{ Parsec} □pprox 3.26 ext{ light-years} □pprox 3.08 imes 10^{16} ext{ metres}$. - **Angstrom ($ ext{\AA}$):** Unit of length used to measure atomic dimensions and light wavelengths. $1 ext{ \AA} = 10^{-10} ext{ m} = 0.1 ext{ nm}$. - **Becquerel (Bq):** SI unit of radioactivity (1 decay per second); traditional non-SI unit is Curie ($1 ext{ Ci} = 3.7 imes 10^{10} ext{ Bq}$). - **Dioptre (D):** Unit of optical power of a lens ($P = ↟rac{1}{f ext{ (in metres)}}$). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Light-year is a unit of DISTANCE, not time! (Distance travelled by light in vacuum in one Julian year $□pprox 9.46 imes 10^{15} ext{ metres}$).

Question 69

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Preamble to the Indian Constitution

Consider the following statements regarding the Preamble of the Indian Constitution: 1. The Preamble is based on the 'Objective Resolution' moved by Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru on December 13, 1946. 2. The words "Socialist", "Secular", and "Integrity" were added to the Preamble by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976. 3. In the Kesavananda Bharati case (1973), the Supreme Court held that the Preamble is NOT a part of the Constitution.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1 and 2 are correct: Pt. Nehru moved the historic Objectives Resolution on 13 Dec 1946 (unanimously adopted on 22 Jan 1947). The 42nd Amendment Act 1976 added three new terms: "Socialist", "Secular", and "and Integrity" (the text changed from "Sovereign Democratic Republic" to "Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic", and "unity of the Nation" to "unity and integrity of the Nation"). - Statement 3 is incorrect: In the **Berubari Union case (1960)**, the SC had held that Preamble is NOT part of the Constitution. BUT in **Kesavananda Bharati (1973)**, the SC explicitly overruled Berubari and held that the **Preamble IS an integral part of the Constitution** and can be amended under Article 368 without destroying its basic structure. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Correct sequence of words in the Preamble: **Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, Republic**! Date of adoption stated in Preamble is **26th November 1949** (Miti Margashirsha Shukla Saptami, Samvat 2006).

Question 70

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Five-Year Plans & Growth Models

Match List-I (Five-Year Plan) with List-II (Underlying Model / Core Strategy) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Plan) A. First Five-Year Plan (1951–56)
B. Second Five-Year Plan (1956–61)
C. Third Five-Year Plan (1961–66)
D. Twelfth Five-Year Plan (2012–17)

List-II (Model / Theme) 1. P.C. Mahalanobis Model (Rapid industrialization & heavy capital goods)
2. Harrod-Domar Model (Agricultural development & price stability)
3. Theme: "Faster, Sustainable, and More Inclusive Growth"
4. John Sandy and Sukhamoy Chakravarty Model (Gadgil Yojana)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **1st Plan (1951–56):** Based on Harrod-Domar growth model; top priority given to agriculture, irrigation, and power (Bhakra Nangal, Hirakud, DVC started). - **2nd Plan (1956–61):** Based on Nehru-Mahalanobis 4-sector model; prioritized heavy engineering and basic industries (Rourkela, Bhilai, Durgapur steel plants). - **3rd Plan (1961–66):** Known as "Gadgil Yojana"; aimed at self-reliant and self-generating economy; suffered setbacks due to 1962 China War, 1965 Pak War, and severe drought (led to Plan Holiday 1966–69). - **12th Plan (2012–17):** Last five-year plan of India; official theme was "Faster, Sustainable and More Inclusive Growth". NITI Aayog replaced Planning Commission on 1 January 2015. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** "Rolling Plan" was introduced by the Janata Party Government under Morarji Desai for 1978–80 based on Gunnar Myrdal's concept!

Question 71

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Historical Inscriptions & Associated Kings

Match List-I (Ancient Inscription) with List-II (Associated King / Composer) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Inscription) A. Aihole Inscription
B. Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar)
C. Junagarh Rock Inscription
D. Mehrauli Iron Pillar Inscription

List-II (King / Composer) 1. Samudragupta (composed by Harishena)
2. Pulakeshin II (composed by Ravikirti)
3. Chandragupta II ('Chandra')
4. Rudradaman I (Saka ruler)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Aihole Inscription (Karnataka):** Written in Sanskrit by court poet Ravikirti; records Chalukya king Pulakeshin II's military conquests and his decisive defeat of King Harsha on the banks of Narmada. - **Prayag Prashasti:** Inscribed on an Ashokan pillar in Allahabad; composed in chaste Sanskrit Champu kavya style by Harishena; catalogues the conquest routes of Gupta emperor Samudragupta (*Napoleon of India*). - **Junagarh Inscription (Gujarat):** First major long inscription in chaste Sanskrit (150 CE) by Saka ruler Rudradaman I; records the history and repairs of the Sudarshana Lake (originally constructed under Chandragupta Maurya and canals added under Ashoka). - **Mehrauli Pillar (Delhi):** Rustless iron pillar commemorating King 'Chandra', universally identified with Gupta emperor Chandragupta II Vikramaditya. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Sudarshana Lake involves 4 rulers: Chandragupta Maurya (built by Pushyagupta) -> Ashoka (canals by Tushaspha) -> Rudradaman I (repaired by Suvisakha) -> Skandagupta (repaired by Chakrapalita).

Question 72

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Planetary & Local Winds

Match List-I (Local Wind) with List-II (Region & Characteristic) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Wind) A. Chinook
B. Sirocco

C. Harmattan
D. Mistral

List-II (Region & Nature) 1. Cold and dry northerly wind blowing down the Rhone valley (France) towards Mediterranean
2. Warm, dry wind on the eastern slopes of the Rocky Mountains ("Snow Eater")
3. Warm, dry, dust-laden wind of West Africa ("Doctor Wind")
4. Hot, dry southerly wind from Sahara causing "Blood Rain" in Southern Italy

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
B. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2
C. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
D. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Chinook:** Warm and dry foehn-type katabatic wind on the leeward (eastern) slopes of Rocky Mountains in USA/Canada; melts snow rapidly, hence called "Snow Eater". - **Sirocco:** Hot, dry, dust-laden wind originating in Sahara; picks up moisture over Mediterranean and causes reddish mud rain ("Blood Rain") in Italy. - **Harmattan:** Dry, dusty trade wind blowing from Sahara southwestward to the Gulf of Guinea; brings welcome relief from humid coastal weather, hence called "The Doctor". - **Mistral:** Cold, violent northerly wind that blows down the Rhone Valley in France towards the Gulf of Lion (Mediterranean). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Cold winds: Mistral (France), Bora (Adriatic coast), Pampero (Argentina), Blizzard (Canada/USA), Buran (Siberia).

Question 73

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Landmark Indian National Congress (INC) Sessions

Match List-I (INC Session) with List-II (President & Significance) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Session) A. 1906 Calcutta Session
B. 1907 Surat Session
C. 1916 Lucknow Session
D. 1929 Lahore Session

List-II (President & Milestone) 1. Rashbehari Ghosh; Formal split between Moderates and Extremists
2. Dadabhai Naoroji; The goal of 'Swaraj' proclaimed for the first time
3. Jawaharlal Nehru; Resolution of 'Purna Swaraj' (Complete Independence) passed
4. Ambica Charan Mazumdar; Lucknow Pact signed between Congress and Muslim League

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **1906 Calcutta:** Presided by Dadabhai Naoroji (Grand Old Man of India); passed resolutions on Swadeshi, Boycott, National Education, and Swaraj. - **1907 Surat:** Presided by Dr. Rashbehari Ghosh on the banks of Tapi; split between Moderates and Extremists (Tilak, Gokhale confrontation). - **1916 Lucknow:** Presided by Ambica Charan Mazumdar; historic reunion of Moderates and Extremists; Congress-League Pact accepted separate electorates for Muslims. - **1929 Lahore:** Presided by Jawaharlal Nehru on the banks of Ravi; adopted 'Purna Swaraj' resolution; tri-colour flag unfurled on midnight of 31 Dec 1929; decided to celebrate 26 January 1930 as Independence Day. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** 1924 Belgaum session was the ONLY session presided over by Mahatma Gandhi! Sarojini Naidu was the first Indian woman president (1925 Kanpur). Annie Besant was the first woman president (1917 Calcutta).

Question 74

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Folk Dances, Music & Traditions of UP

Match List-I (Folk Dance / Music Form) with List-II (Region of Uttar Pradesh) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Folk Form) A. Charkula Dance
B. Alha Folk Song
C. Kajari Song
D. Birha Song

List-II (Region in UP) 1. Bundelkhand
2. Braj Region (Mathura)

3. Purvanchal (Bhojpuri Belt)
4. Mirzapur & Varanasi

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Charkula Dance:** Performed in the Braj region; women dance carrying a heavy multi-tiered wooden pyramid with 108 illuminated oil lamps balanced on their heads. - **Alha:** Heroic ballads celebrating the chivalry of Bundelkhand warrior brothers Alha and Udal (generals of Chandel king Paramardi Deva). - **Kajari:** Traditional semi-classical monsoon singing associated primarily with Mirzapur, Varanasi, and surrounding Eastern UP. - **Birha:** Popular narrative folk singing genre of the Yadav/Ahir community in the Bhojpuri/Purvanchal region. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Nautanki is associated with Hathras and Kanpur traditions. Raslila is Braj. Hori and Phag are Awadh and Braj.

Question 75

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Major National & International Literary Awards 2024

Consider the following statements regarding premier literary and cultural awards: 1. The 58th Jnanpith Award was conferred jointly upon celebrated Urdu poet Gulzar and Sanskrit scholar Jagadguru Rambhadracharya. 2. The 33rd Saraswati Samman was awarded to Malayalam poet Prabha Varma for his verse novel *Roudrasathwikam*. 3. The Booker Prize 2024 was awarded to British author Samantha Harvey for her novel *Orbital*.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **58th Jnanpith Award (for 2023, announced 2024):** Conferred upon lyricist/filmmaker Gulzar (Sampooran Singh Kalra) for Urdu and Jagadguru Rambhadracharya for Sanskrit (second time Sanskrit has received Jnanpith after Satyavrat Shastri in 2006). - **33rd Saraswati Samman (KK Birla Foundation):** Conferred on noted Malayalam poet Prabha Varma for his work *Roudrasathwikam*. - **Booker Prize 2024:** Won by Samantha Harvey for *Orbital*, a compact novel set over 24 hours aboard the International Space Station (first space-themed novel to win the Booker Prize). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** 33rd Vyas Samman was awarded to renowned Hindi writer **Pushpa Bharati** for her memoir *Yaadein, Yaadein aur Yaadein*! International Booker Prize 2024 was won by German writer **Jenny Erpenbeck** for *Kairos* (translated by Michael Hofmann).